



PRINTERS (INKJET)

Due to fierce competition between the major players in the printer market, costs have fallen drastically, making inkjet printers more and more affordable. A year ago, an entry-level inkjet printer would cost around Rs 6,000 to Rs 7,000. Today those figures are around Rs 2,500 to 4,000. The competition has also made manufacturers think about add-ons, like support for memory sticks, and direct printing from digital cameras. In this competitive scenario, we tested a range of printers.

The Canon S530D was the most feature-rich printer in our comparison tests. Its support for nearly all possible technologies makes it a one-stop printing solution. Whether printing from a PC or a digital camera, it assures that you have total control over the output.

The printer comes with the USB 2.0 interface for faster data transfer, and a Compact Flash (CF) card reader that you can insert in any digital camera and take printouts directly. Canon was thoughtful and generous enough to provide a CF adapter too.

Canon S530D Photo Printer

+ USB 2.0, Compact Flash (CF) card reader, cables for printing from a digital camera

– Expensive

Price: Rs 24,995

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Reviewed in:

October 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: HP Deskjet 970CXi

2001: Epson Stylus Color 880

The printer's interface is an LCD screen that offers full control over settings such as paper type, ink quality, etc. It also indicates the number of photographs that you need printed. If you want to print thumbnails of all the images on the CF card, you can do so from the LCD console.

WORTHY MENTIONS

HP DeskJet 6122

+ 8 MB buffer, very accurate colour reproduction

– Data cable not provided

Price: Rs 10,500

Contact: Hewlett-Packard India Ltd

Phone: 011-2682 6000

E-mail: ashwini-k_aggarwal@hp.com

Reviewed in: April 2003

HP DeskJet 3325

+ Great price, good performance

– Only 768 KB of internal buffer

Price: Rs 2,999

Contact: Hewlett-Packard India Ltd

Phone: 011-2682 6000

E-mail: ashwini-k_aggarwal@hp.com

Reviewed in: April 2003

Also provided are cables for printing from a digital camera. Other details such as the placement of buttons and the compact flash slot—all of which are easily accessible—go into making this printer a true winner.

PRINTERS (LASER)

The Samsung ML-1710 comes in a milky white body, decorated in slate grey. Despite its small size (13.7 x 14 x 7.6 inches), the printer features a removable paper tray, capable of holding around 250 sheets. The upper body serves as the output tray, and can hold about 40 sheets.

As far as specifications are concerned, the ML-1710 boasts of an 8 MB memory buffer, which is quite effective. The downside is that the memory can't be upgraded. The printer comes with the USB 1.1 interface. Samsung has done a good job of providing drivers for a host of operating systems. Bundled accessories include a 15A power cord and an extensive manual.

The printer comes with a toner-save feature, which, Samsung claims, saves as much as 40 per cent on ink. Samsung claims that the ML-1710 is the fastest and the smallest laser printer, and they're right. The printer was able to print at 15 ppm. The quality of the output was also great, considering the speed. It printed the test image and combination-document in just 17 seconds and 22 seconds respectively—

Samsung ML-1710

+ 8 MB memory, toner saver button, water marking, high altitude correction

– Output tray can hold only approx. 40 sheets above which papers fly out, USB cable not bundled

Price: Rs 16,000

Contact: Samsung Electronics

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Reviewed in:

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PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: Canon LBP1210

2001: Lexmark Optra M412

by far the fastest we've seen.

The lack of network support and small paper handling capacity means that it's not really suited for large organisations or

WORTHY MENTIONS

Canon LBP 1210

+ USB and parallel interface, 250-sheet paper capacity

– Interface cables not bundled

Price: Rs 13,500

Contact: Canon India Ltd

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Reviewed in: January 2003

Samsung ML-1510

+ Bundled interface cables, 250-sheet paper capacity, remarkably small and light

– No LCD display

Price: Rs 11,000

Contact: Samsung Electronics India Information & Telecommunication Ltd

Phone: 011-5151 1234

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Reviewed in: November 2003

offices. However, at Rs 16,000, it's ideally suited for a typical small office and as a home printing solution.